

Interviewer: Let's get started. So, how would you like us to refer to your partner during the interview?

Interviewee: My wife.

Interviewer: Your wife, okay. And how long have you been together?

Interviewee: It's been [16-20] years. Well, it's been over [16-20] years.

Interviewer: I'd like you to tell me about your history with your wife, what you're experiencing currently.

Interviewee: Actually, we met in high school at a party at some friends' house, a mutual friend we had. And we met there. I had just gone through a breakup not long before, I think. And then, we... And it clicked pretty quickly, but it took us a while to start dating because she made me chase her a bit. But afterward, we would see each other at school, then we eventually got together. And there were some big debates at first because long-distance relationships when we were younger were complicated, but after high school, in the early years of university, we got together and we haven't parted since.

Interviewer: You were in a long-distance relationship in high school?

Interviewee: Actually, in high school, we were in the same... In the same city. And then, she went to study in [City A]. She went for [1-5] year to prepare for [exams], sorry. And they went more or less well. And she actually switched to [Major]. And then she moved to the city where I was because she needed to be closer anyway. And then, every time she came back on vacation, we would see each other, and we would get back together. And every time she left, I told her that long-distance relationships wouldn't work. She didn't have enough confidence in me to maintain a long-distance relationship. So, once we were both in [City B], it was good. And now, it's me who leaves for work, and the long-distance relationship still works.

Interviewer: You leave for work...

Interviewee: I work on [Job]. I go on [Jobs] regularly. Throughout the year, I spend between [1-5] and [1-5] months at [Job]. And so, for periods ranging from one week to [1-5] month and a half.

Interviewer: Okay, I see...

Interviewee: I'm using my phone's hotspot, and my battery is running low, so it might have been on my end. I plugged it in, so it should be fine now. We have issues with our box.

Interviewer: You were telling me that you leave for about [1-5] months, in periods of [1-5] weeks.

Interviewee: Yes, from [1-5] week to [6-10] weeks. I go to [Job] for [Jobs] all over the world. And during that time, we're apart, so it's communication through [Social Media] or email. And with the kids, it's not easy.

Interviewer: Since your studies, you've been together. And how has it evolved? You mentioned the kids, so how...

Interviewee: At first, we got together while we were in [City B]. She didn't want us to live in the same apartment. We each had our own places, but only 400 meters apart. But we were always at each other's places. Then, after [1-5] years like that, we got an apartment together the following year. After that, I had [1-5] year of professional training, so I was commuting between two places. And after she finished her studies in [City A] for her master's, she came back to [City B], and we bought a house. A few years later, we got married. And once married, the kids came naturally. She didn't want kids before marriage; she wanted to get through work first.

Interviewer: So, you've been together for [16-20] years now. How is it going?

Interviewee: It's going well. Otherwise, we wouldn't still be together.

Interviewer: Okay. If you had to compare your relationship with your wife to that of your friends with their wives, what would you say?

Interviewee: I don't like comparing, actually. I think relationships are an alchemy between two people. So, it depends on each person's character, their history, and their interests. I tend not to compare with my friends. I see things in our relationship that might be lacking in others. The fact that I go to [Job] regularly, we've kept a certain freshness in our relationship. We miss each other when I'm gone, and when we reunite, we break the routine. But other friends are more stuck in a routine. We need to trust each other, especially when I'm at [Job]. We're not as interdependent as some other couples. To be good in your relationship, you need to be balanced yourself. Otherwise, you're just compensating for personal imbalances in the relationship, which throws the other off balance.

Interviewer: And if you compared it to your previous relationships, I don't know if there were any...

Interviewee: Yes, there were plenty. I'd say none were as serious or deep as this. We know each other much better, and it's a lot more profound. We've gone through many stages together over time.

Interviewer: Hmm. You mentioned trust. How would you describe a high-quality relationship?

Interviewee: Knowing yourself well, knowing the other person's strengths and weaknesses, accepting them, and finding the right words when something isn't going well. A lot of listening and sharing. Lowering your pride to avoid confrontation. In some couples, there's constant clashing because each person is too proud to let the other have the last word. With us, there's more tolerance, empathy, and listening.

Interviewer: Hmm. How do you know you're in such a relationship through communication?

Interviewee: Through communication. Telling each other what's going well and what isn't, listening without being defensive, and sharing.

Interviewer: Hmm. How would you describe a low-quality relationship?

Interviewee: Not being able to rely on the other person, judgment, not being able to express when something's wrong, hiding aspects of yourself, not being yourself, and not having true moments together as a couple. Living alongside each other without really seeing each other, being in pretense.

Interviewer: When has your relationship been at its highest quality?

Interviewee: Ah! There are always moments throughout the evolution of a relationship that are of higher quality in certain aspects. Spending time together makes these moments of higher quality.

Interviewer: And when was it at its lowest quality?

Interviewee: When we were younger and doing long distance. We didn't have enough confidence in ourselves and each other, leading to jealousy and tension.

Interviewer: Are there other important aspects for you in a relationship?

Interviewee: Complicity, a sense of humor, knowing how to laugh together, sharing quality time, doing projects together, and having the same vision.

Interviewer: And what does love mean to you?

Interviewee: Love starts with an attraction or a look, evolves into complicity, sharing, supporting each other, and being there for each other in difficult times.

Interviewer: How important is love in a relationship?

Interviewee: It's very important. It encompasses a lot of things. Love must be present, and it evolves over time.

Interviewer: Is love different depending on who it's directed towards?

Interviewee: I think so. It's a chemistry between two people.

Interviewer: How do you know your wife loves you?

Interviewee: Through little attentions and moments of complicity. She knows when I need time for myself or for us as a couple.

Interviewer: Can you tell me about a recent negative interaction?

Interviewee: We're doing renovations, so there are small reproaches about choices we made together, leading to minor conflicts.

Interviewer: What are the major conflicts about?

Interviewee: When I go to [Job], my wife is overwhelmed with the kids. She needs a break when I return, but the kids are very attached to her, which leads to frustration and tension.

Interviewer: Do you have challenges in your relationship?

Interviewee: The distance when I'm at [Job] is a big challenge, as well as managing the kids and renovations. We try to organize and communicate to handle these challenges.

Interviewer: How do you manage the organization?

Interviewee: By communicating, planning, and involving our families for support.

Interviewer: Do you make decisions together to avoid conflicts?

Interviewee: We try to anticipate and organize our schedules to manage everything together.

Interviewer: Can you tell me about a recent positive interaction?

Interviewee: We chose new blinds together, a decision my wife was happy with, which felt positive.

Interviewer: Besides communication and organization, how else do you maintain your relationship?

Interviewee: Sharing moments of complicity, doing sports together, and having common interests outside of daily life.

Interviewer: What could make you leave your wife?

Interviewee: If the relationship became toxic, with no more complicity or empathy, or if there were malicious actions. But we've chosen each other knowing this won't happen.

Interviewer: What do you mean by malicious actions?

Interviewee: Deliberate actions to annoy or hurt the other person.

Interviewer: Do you think this relationship is good for you?

Interviewee: Yes. It brings out the best in me and helps me grow.

Interviewer: Has your wife changed over time?

Interviewee: Yes, she was more introverted with strangers before but has opened up more.

Interviewer: Do you agree on your children's education?

Interviewee: Yes, we discuss it a lot. My wife is a [Job B], which helps.

Interviewer: Do you feel secure in this relationship?

Interviewee: Yes, without a doubt.

Interviewer: How important is sexuality in your relationship?

Interviewee: It's quite important. It reflects the health of the relationship and is a moment of complicity and fun.

Interviewer: Are you satisfied with your sex life?

Interviewee: Yes, but there's always room for improvement.

Interviewer: What's the frequency of your sexual relations?

Interviewee: It's not about the frequency but the intensity and connection during the act.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Interviewee: Very satisfied. I wouldn't say completely satisfied because there's always room for improvement.

Interviewer: On a scale of 0 to 10, how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Interviewee: 8.5. There's always room for improvement, but I'm grateful for what we have.

Interviewer: Why 8.5?

Interviewee: Because there are always small things to improve. But we realize how lucky we are to have such a complementary relationship.